

# UEFA European Championship

The European Championship began in 1960 as the European Nations' Cup. Early final tournaments had only four teams. The modern EURO expanded to eight teams in 1980, sixteen in 1996, and twenty-four in 2016.

UEFA European Championship editions, 1960 onward

| Year | Host(s)                | Teams | Winner | Runner-up | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final             |
|------|------------------------|-------|--------|-----------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------|
| 2024 | Germany                | 24    | Spain  | England   | France             | Netherlands                 | Spain 2-1 England |
| 2020 | Eleven European cities | 24    | Italy  | England   | Spain              | Denmark                     | 1-1; Italy pens   |

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|------|----------------------------|-------|----------|-----------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 2016 | France                     | 24    | Portugal | France    | Germany            | Wales                       | Portugal 1-0<br>France (a.p.) |
| 2012 | Poland and<br>Ukraine      | 16    | Spain    | Italy     | Germany            | Portugal                    | Spain 4-0<br>Germany          |
| 2008 | Austria and<br>Switzerland | 16    | Spain    | Germany   | Russia             | Türkiye                     | Spain 1-0<br>Germany          |
| 2004 | Portugal                   | 16    | Greece   | Portugal  | Czech Republic     | Netherlands                 | Greece 1-0<br>Portugal        |

| Year | Host(s)                 | Teams | Winner             | Runner-up      | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                               |
|------|-------------------------|-------|--------------------|----------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 2000 | Belgium and Netherlands | 16    | <b>France</b>      | Italy          | Portugal           | Netherlands                 | France 2–1 Italy (gold goal)        |
| 1996 | England                 | 16    | <b>Germany</b>     | Czech Republic | England            | France                      | Germany 2–1 Czech Rep (golden goal) |
| 1992 | Sweden                  | 8     | <b>Denmark</b>     | Germany        | Netherlands        | Sweden                      | Denmark 1–0 Germany                 |
| 1988 | West Germany            | 8     | <b>Netherlands</b> | Soviet Union   | West Germany       | Italy                       | Netherlands 1–0 Soviet Union        |
| 1984 | France                  | 8     | <b>France</b>      | Spain          | Portugal           | Denmark                     | France 2–0 Spain                    |

| Year | Host(s)    | Teams | Winner                | Runner-up       | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                               |
|------|------------|-------|-----------------------|-----------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1980 | Italy      | 8     | <b>West Germany</b>   | Belgium         | Czechoslovakia     | Italy                       | West Gern<br>2-1 Belgiu             |
| 1976 | Yugoslavia | 4     | <b>Czechoslovakia</b> | West<br>Germany | Netherlands        | Yugoslavia                  | 2-2;<br>Czechoslo<br>5-3 pens       |
| 1972 | Belgium    | 4     | <b>West Germany</b>   | Soviet<br>Union | Belgium            | Hungary                     | West Gern<br>3-0 Soviet<br>Union    |
| 1968 | Italy      | 4     | <b>Italy</b>          | Yugoslavia      | England            | Soviet Union                | Italy 2-0<br>Yugoslavia<br>(replay) |
| 1964 | Spain      | 4     | <b>Spain</b>          | Soviet<br>Union | Hungary            | Denmark                     | Spain 2-1<br>Soviet Uni             |

| Year | Host(s) | Teams | Winner              | Runner-up  | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                               |
|------|---------|-------|---------------------|------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1960 | France  | 4     | <b>Soviet Union</b> | Yugoslavia | Czechoslovakia     | France                      | Soviet Uni<br>2–1 Yugos<br>(a.e.t.) |

 **Champions by titles**

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

|                                                                        |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Spain</b><br><div></div><br>1964, 2008, 2012, 2024                  | <b>4</b> |
| <b>Germany (incl. West Germany)</b><br><div></div><br>1972, 1980, 1996 | <b>3</b> |
| <b>Italy</b><br><div></div><br>1968, 2020                              | <b>2</b> |

|                                                                                     |          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>France</b>                                                                       | <b>2</b> |
|    |          |
| 1984, 2000                                                                          |          |
| <b>Soviet Union</b>                                                                 | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 1960                                                                                |          |
| <b>Czechoslovakia</b>                                                               | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 1976                                                                                |          |
| <b>Netherlands</b>                                                                  | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 1988                                                                                |          |
| <b>Denmark</b>                                                                      | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 1992                                                                                |          |
| <b>Greece</b>                                                                       | <b>1</b> |
|    |          |
| 2004                                                                                |          |
| <b>Portugal</b>                                                                     | <b>1</b> |
|  |          |
| 2016                                                                                |          |

### **Historical format note**

A third-place match was played through 1980. From 1984 onward, UEFA recognizes both defeated semifinalists without ranking them third and fourth. The table therefore uses neutral “other semifinalist” wording.

### **Memorable moments**

- Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.

- Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.
- Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
- Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.
- The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
- Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

## References & review

**Status:** review

Last reviewed: 13 August 2026

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.